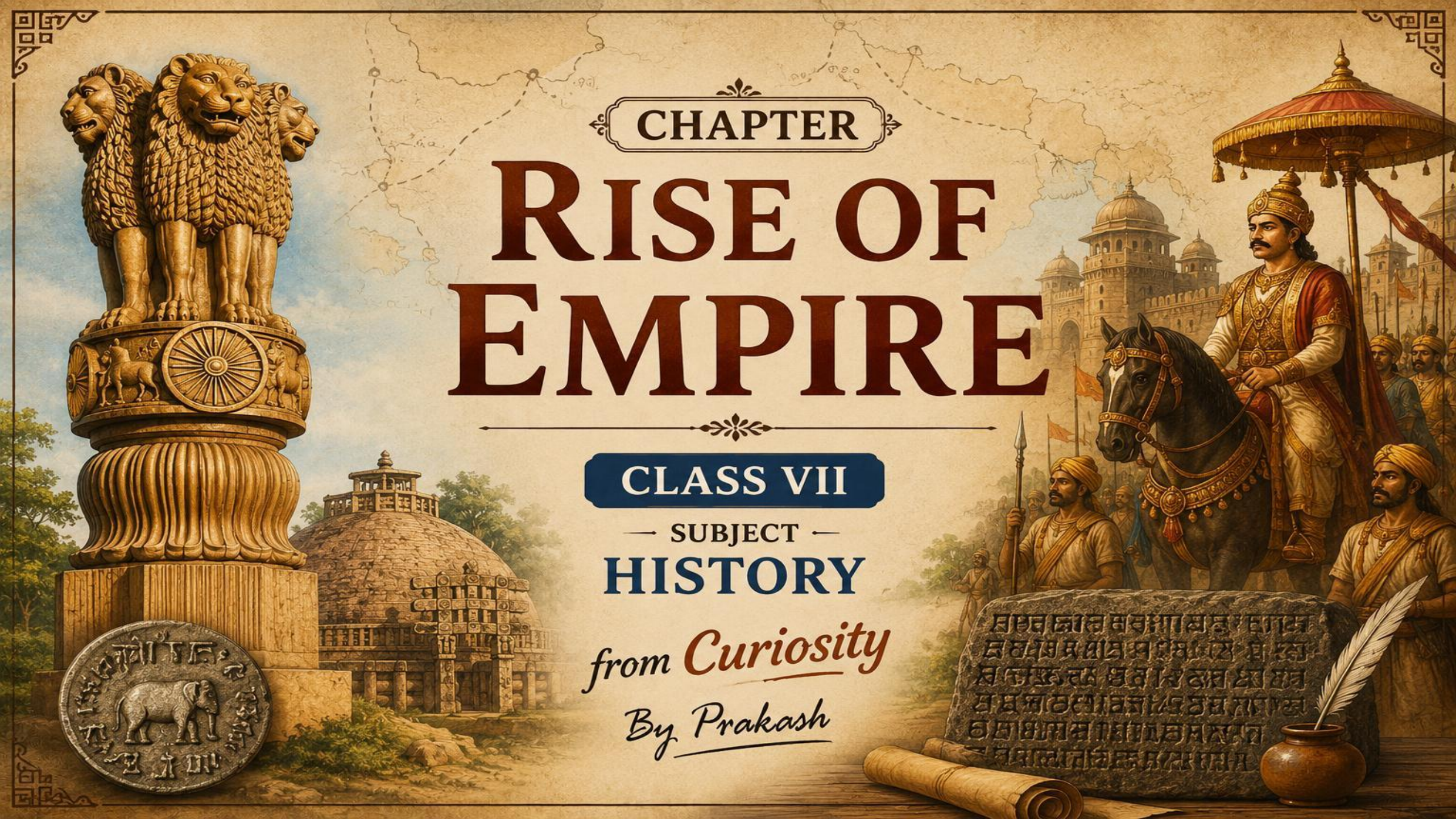




CHAPTER

RISE OF EMPIRE

CLASS VII

— SUBJECT —

HISTORY

from *Curiosity*

By Prakash

EMPIRE AND KINGDOM



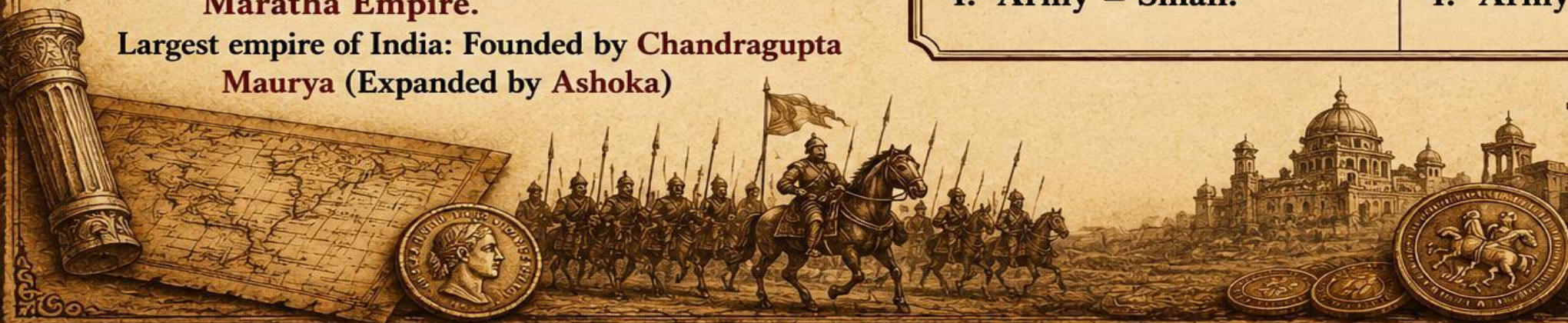
EMPIRE

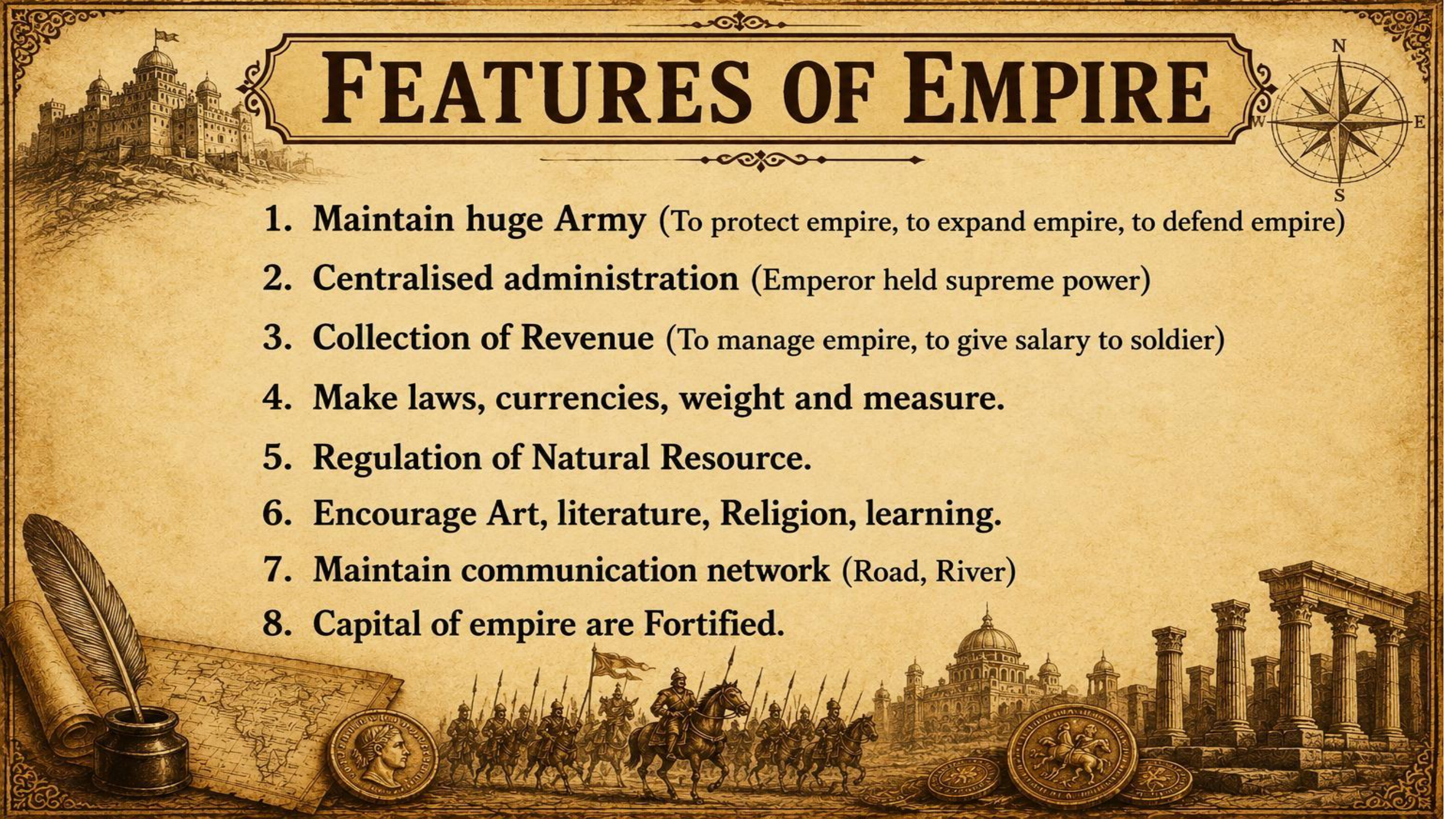
- * Latin word → **Imperium** (Supreme Power)
- * Empire = collection of multiple kingdoms/territories.
Large area consisting of multiple kingdom.
- * Empire was ruled by **Emperor** (Supreme Ruler)
- * Indian word for Emperor:
 - a) **Samraj** = Supreme Ruler
 - b) **Adhiraja** = overlord
 - c) **Rajadhiraja** = king of kings
- * Eg → **Mauryan Empire, Ottoman Empire, Maratha Empire.**

Largest empire of India: Founded by **Chandragupta Maurya** (Expanded by **Ashoka**)

COMPARISON BETWEEN KINGDOM AND EMPIRE

KINGDOM	EMPIRE
1. Size = Small area.	1. Size = Large area (contain multiple kingdoms)
2. Ruler = King.	2. Ruler = Emperor.
3. Revenue collection = Low.	3. Revenue collection = High.
4. Army = Small.	4. Army = Large.

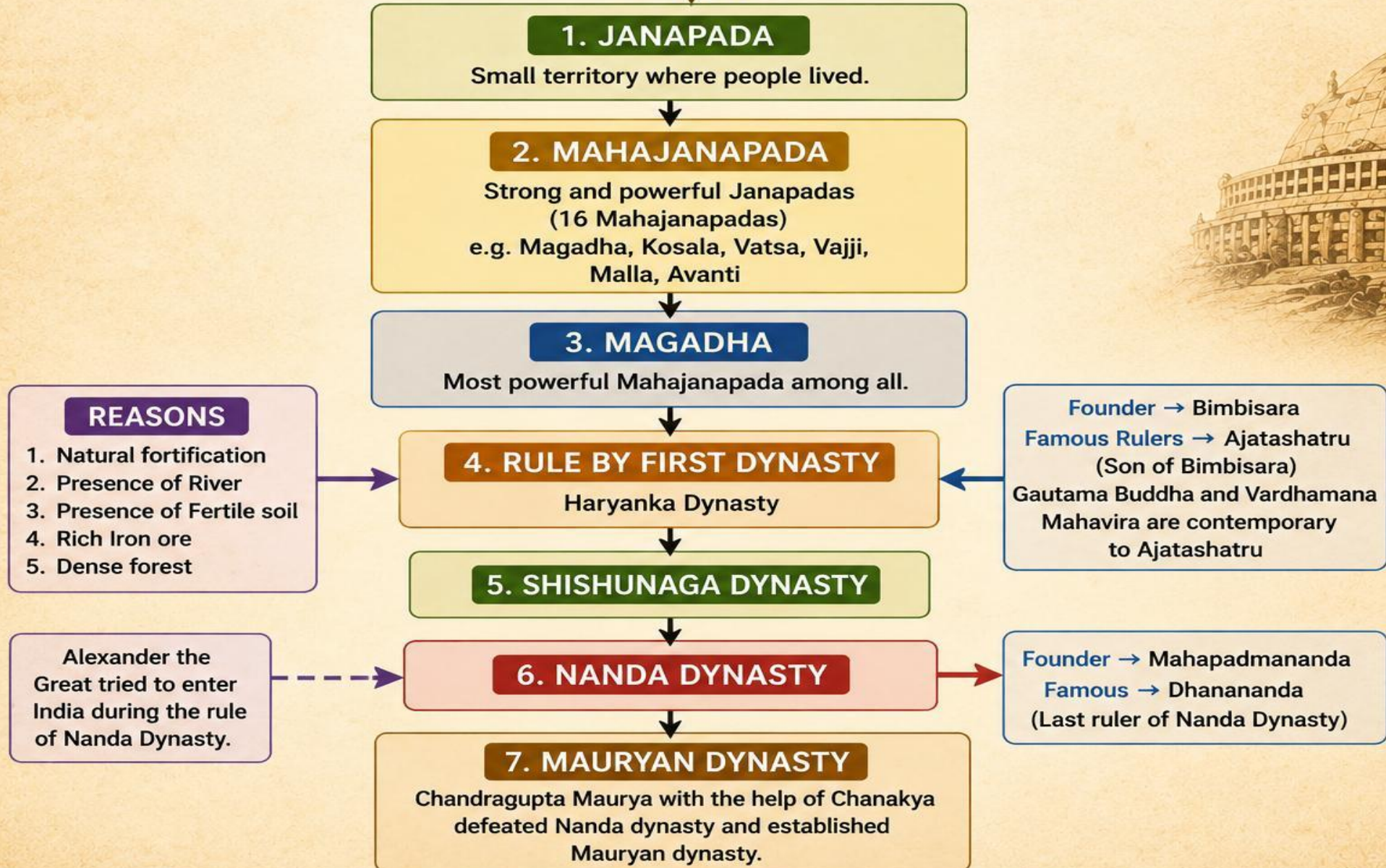




FEATURES OF EMPIRE

1. **Maintain huge Army** (To protect empire, to expand empire, to defend empire)
2. **Centralised administration** (Emperor held supreme power)
3. **Collection of Revenue** (To manage empire, to give salary to soldier)
4. **Make laws, currencies, weight and measure.**
5. **Regulation of Natural Resource.**
6. **Encourage Art, literature, Religion, learning.**
7. **Maintain communication network** (Road, River)
8. **Capital of empire are Fortified.**

RISE OF MAURYAN EMPIRE



ARRIVAL OF GREEKS – ALEXANDER

1. PLACE

Macedon (Greece)

2. AIM

To conquer the world / To reach end of the world.

3. WAR

Alexander defeated Persian king.
Alexander defeated PORUS (Punjab Region)

{ Alexander defeated Porus but treated him with honoured.
He made Porus a SATRAP (Provincial Governor). }

4. REASONS

1. Soldiers were exhausted due to continuous war.
2. Soldiers were missing their families and homeland.
3. Alexander and his soldiers were brutally attacked by local Rulers.
4. News of elephants, huge army and unfavourable terrain of India.

5. GYMNOSOPHIST

Indian sages called by Alexander (Greeks).



CHANDRAGUPTA MAURYA

1. FOUNDER OF MAURYAN EMPIRE

Chandragupta Maurya
(Founder of Mauryan Empire)

2. SON

Son = Bindusara, Grandson = Ashoka.

3. KAUTILYA

Mentor of Chandragupta Maurya.
(*Kautilya Guide Chandragupta Maurya
in his administration.*)

4. SELEUCUS NICATOR (SATRAP)

Chandragupta Maurya defeated Seleucus Nicator
and took control over NW part of India.

5. MEGASTHENES

Greek Historian and diplomat.

- Helps in maintain relation of India with Greece.
- He lived in the court of Chandragupta Maurya.
- He wrote a book = **INDIKA**

This book tells about society and
governance of mauryan empire.



Statue of Chandragupta Maurya



Megasthenes in the court of Chandragupta Maurya
(A 20th-century painting by Asit Kumar Haldar)

CHANDRAGUPTA MAURYA

1. FOUNDER OF MAURYAN EMPIRE

Chandragupta Maurya
(Founder of Mauryan Empire)

2. CAPITAL

Pataliputra (Patna)

3. FAMOUS

First largest Empire of India

4. KEY RULERS

Chandragupta Maurya, Bindusara, Ashoka

5. LAST RULER

Brihadratha (Killed by his official – Pushyamitra Shunga)

6. ARMY

Large standing Army
(Infantry, Cavalry, Elephant, Chariots)

7. ECONOMY

Agriculture
(Main occupation)

8. RELIGION

Tolerate all religion
(Respect all religion)

Chandragupta
Follower of Jainism
(Vardhaman Mahavira)

Ashoka
Follower of Buddhism
(Gautam Buddha)

Ashoka adopted
Buddhism after
Kalinga War

10. DECLINE

Weak successor after Ashoka, low tax collection,
weak centralised administration.

EXTENT OF MAURYAN EMPIRE UNDER CHANDRAGUPTA MAURYA

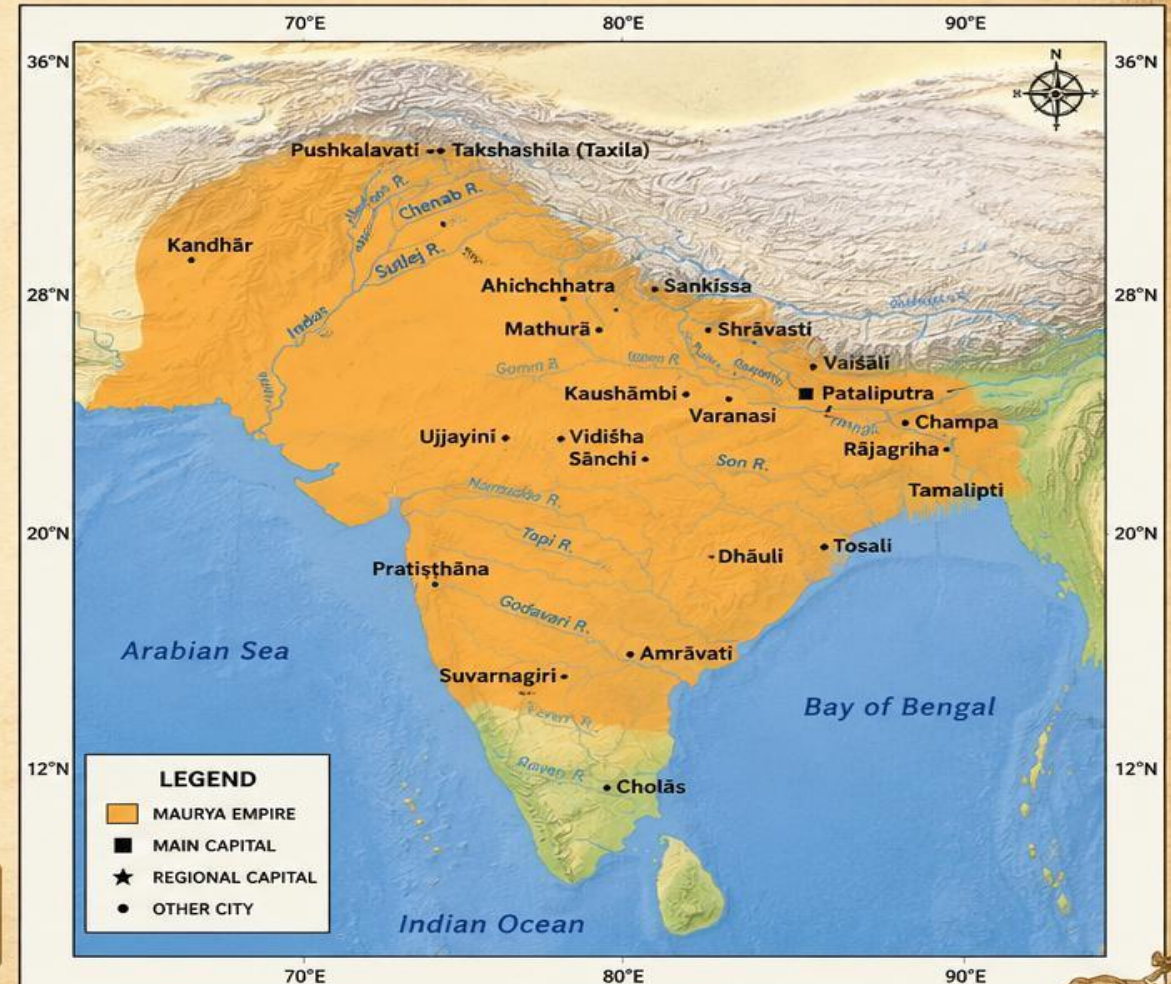


Fig. 5.13. Maurya Empire

KAUTILYA



1. TEACHER

Teacher of Takshashila.



2. MENTOR

Mentor of Chandragupta Maurya.



3. ALSO CALLED

Also called Chanakya and Vishnugupta.



4. AUTHOR OF BOOK

Wrote the book – *Arthashastra*.
(Gives information about administration and economy of Mauryan Empire.)



5. COMPOSED – SAPTANGA

Composed Saptanga
(Seven important parts of Kingdom)

1 Swami



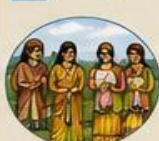
King

2 Amatya



Officials /
Ministers

3 Janapada



Territory with
population

4 Durga



Fortified
towns and cities

5 Kosha



Treasury /
Wealth / Money

6 Danda



Forces of defence,
law and order

7 Mitra

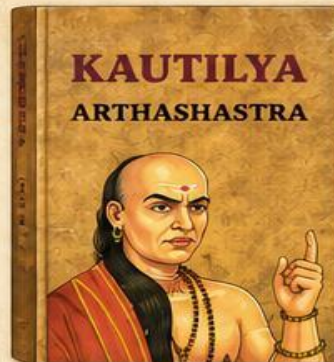


Allies

SUMMARY

Kautilya's *Arthashastra* is a great treatise on administration, statecraft and economy.

KAUTILYA'S BOOK – ARTHASHASTRA



Arthashastra gives
information about
administration and
economy of
Mauryan Empire.



KAUTILYA'S SAPTANGA (SEVEN IMPORTANT PARTS OF KINGDOM)



the king (*swami*)



the group of councillors,
ministers and other
high officials (*amatya*)



the territory of the state
along with the population
inhabiting it (*janapada*)



the fortified towns
and cities (*durga*)



the treasury or the
wealth of the kingdom
(*kosha*)



the allies (*mitra*)



the forces of defence
and law and order (*danda*)



MEGASTHENES



1. WHO WAS HE?

Megasthenes was a **Greek historian** and **diplomat**.



2. HE LIVED IN

He lived in the court of **Chandragupta Maurya**.



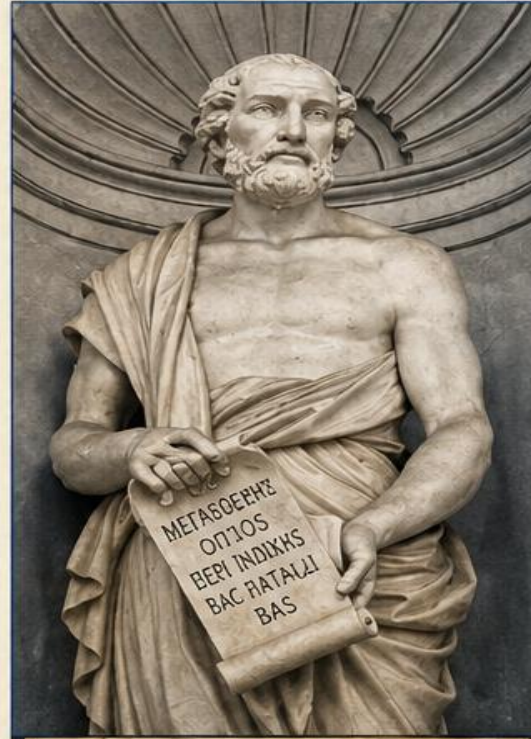
3. BOOK HE WROTE

He wrote a book – **INDIKA**.



4. INFORMATION GIVEN

His book Indika gives information about **the social life and administration** under **Mauryan Empire**.



Megasthenes
(Greek Historian and Diplomat)

MEGASTHENES IN THE COURT OF CHANDRAGUPTA MAURYA

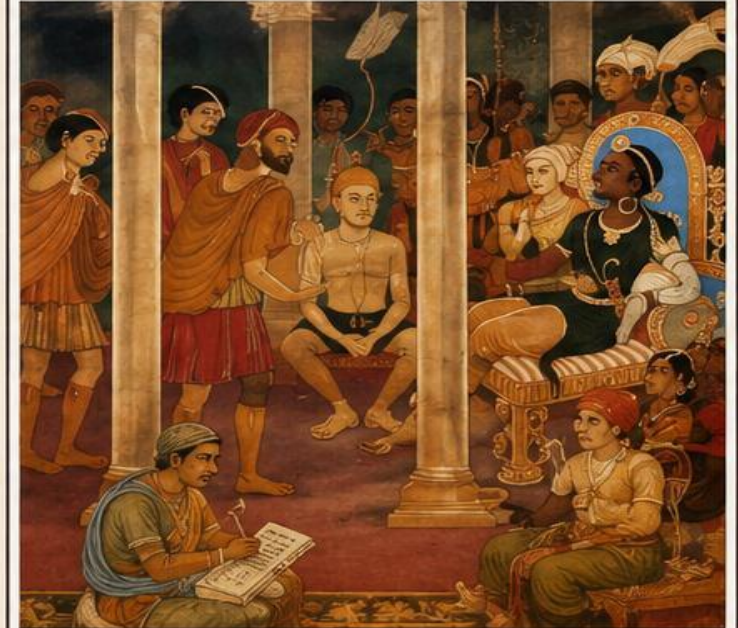


Fig. 5.14. Megasthenes in the court of Chandragupta Maurya
(A 20th-century painting by Asit Kumar Haldar)

SUMMARY

Megasthenes was a Greek historian and diplomat who lived in the court of Chandragupta Maurya. He wrote the book Indika, which gives valuable information about the social life and administration under the Mauryan Empire.



POLICY OF DHAMMA



1. DHAMMA (DHAMMA)

- Code of conduct / Social Responsibilities
- Duties of a person towards its society



2. PRINCIPLES OF DHAMMA

- 1) Respect to parents and Elder
- 2) Follow **Ahimsa** (Non-violence)
- 3) Respect to all Religion
- 4) Truthful and honest
- 5) Work for welfare of society



3. METHODS TO SPREAD DHAMMA

- 1) Messages of dhamma are spread through writing on pillar (**Rock edicts**)
- 2) Appointed **Dhamma Mahamatas** to spread messages of dhamma.



4. LANGUAGE

Message of dhamma were spread in **Prakrit language** – language of ordinary people.



Fig. 5.18. (Left) A reproduction of a part of Ashoka rock edict at Girnar, Gujarat.
(Right) Detail of the Topra Ashokan pillar at Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi.



Fig. 5.16. Ashoka visiting the Ramagrama stupa in Nepal (from a panel at the Sanchi stupa)

SOURCES OF MAURYAN EMPIRE

1. ARCHAEOLOGICAL SOURCES



1

ASHOKAN EDICTS (Messages written on Pillar and Rocks)

- Language of writing → Prakrit language
- Writing style → Brahmi Script (left to right)
- Contain information about Ashoka's Dhamma policy



Ashokan Edicts (Rock Edict)

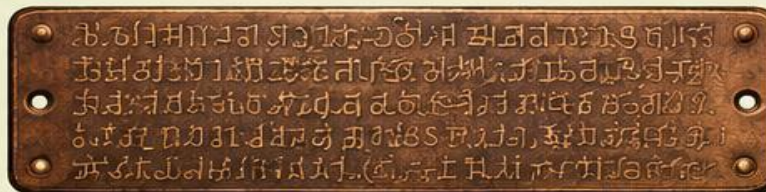
- Messages written on rocks and pillars
- Written in Prakrit language using Brahmi Script
- Contain information about Ashoka's Dhamma policy



2

SOHGAURA COPPER PLATE INSCRIPTION

- Written on copper plate
- Contain administrative records of Mauryan empire



Sohgaura Copper Plate Inscription

- Written on copper plate
- Contain administrative records of Mauryan empire



3

STUPA

A Buddhist mound built to enclose relics of Buddha.



Stupa

A Buddhist mound built to enclose relics of Buddha.



4

ASHOKAN PILLAR

Stone pillars erected by Ashoka with edicts to spread Dhamma.



Ashokan Pillar

Stone pillars erected by Ashoka with edicts to spread Dhamma.

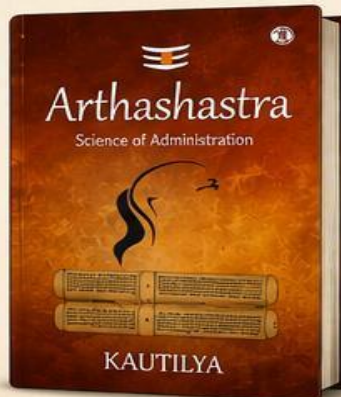
2. LITERARY SOURCES (BOOKS)



1

ARTHASHASTRA

Contain administrative and economic records.



ARTHASHASTRA

A treatise written by Kautilya (Chanakya). It contains detailed information about administration, state system, economy, law and governance.



2

INDIKA

Contain administrative and social life records.



INDIKA

Written by Megasthenes, the Greek ambassador in the Mauryan court. It provides information about administration and social life.





LIFE UNDER MAURYAN EMPIRE



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1. SOCIETY

- 1 Varna-based society.
- 2 Main social groups – Brahman, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra.
- 3 Followed Dharma – respect for parents and elders.
- 4 Religion – Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism. (All religions were respected)



2. ADMINISTRATION

- 1 Centralised administration.
- 2 Emperor – Supreme Ruler.
- 3 Officials were appointed for administration.
- 4 Maintain large standing Army.
- 5 Well-organised system of law and order.
- 6 Local administration by village officers.



3. ECONOMY

- 1 Main occupation – Agriculture.
- 2 Two crops grown per year (Summer and Winter).
- 3 Grains were stored in Granary to prevent famine.
- 4 Other occupations – Potter, Blacksmith, Carpenter and other artisans.
- 5 Trade and commerce were also important.



4. REVENUE

- 1 Tax were collected from land, crop and trade.

